

PROTEIN — HOW MUCH DO I ACTUALLY NEED?

A clear range, without the internet arms race.

Protein advice online runs from “barely more than the RDA” to “2.2 g per kg or you’re leaving gains on the table.” Both extremes create confusion. For people who train and want to build or protect muscle, the useful range is narrower and more practical than the arguments suggest.

THE WORKING RANGE

1.4–1.6 g per kg bodyweight

Start at **1.4 g** per kilogram. If recovery and progress feel slow after consistent training, move toward **1.6 g**.

Example: 75 kg person → about 105–120 g protein per day.

Resistance-training meta-analyses show most of the benefit for muscle occurs up to ~1.6 g/kg for the average trainee.

WHEN YOU MIGHT GO HIGHER

In a hard calorie deficit, higher protein (toward 1.8–2.0 g/kg) can help protect muscle. Advanced trainees sometimes benefit from the top of the range.

For most people in energy balance or a slight surplus, 1.4–1.6 g done every day outperforms higher targets done sporadically.

Consistency beats the theoretical maximum.

× COMMON FOLLY

- ✗ **Chasing 2 g+ by default.** Extra protein beyond what the body uses for tissue and energy is not stored as extra muscle. Surplus energy can contribute to fat gain like any other surplus. More is not automatically better.
- ✗ **Assuming the RDA is optimal for training.** The RDA (~0.8 g/kg) is set to prevent deficiency in sedentary people. It is not a target for someone building or protecting muscle under load.
- ✗ **Only counting shakes.** Whole food — eggs, meat, fish, dairy, legumes — counts. A shake is a tool, not the foundation.

EASY WAYS TO HIT IT

Eggs. High biological value, easy to add.

One anchor food most days — meat, fish, dairy, or a legume dish you actually like.

Spread it. Protein at the first real meal plus later meals beats one huge sitting.

You do not need perfect distribution. You need the daily total to be real most days of the week.

CHECK YOURSELF

For one week, estimate what you actually get. Most people who “eat plenty of protein” are lower than they think when they write it down.

Bite It—Write It for seven days. Adjust from the page, not from the story.

Next step: Calculate 1.4 g × your weight in kg. Aim there for two weeks. Notice recovery and hunger. Free programme at beinghaware.github.io/BHAFL.